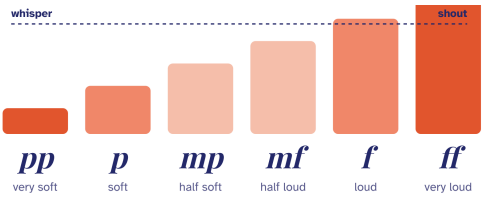
EXPRESSION · LOUD AND SOFT · LEARN

Loud and soft



REMEMBER pp p mp mf f ff: from a whisper to a shout. **m** (mezzo) means half; a second letter means very.

1 Say it ★☆☆

Write the Italian name and what it means. The first row is done.

SIGN	NAME	MEANS
p	piano	soft
mf		
ff		
mp		
pp		
f		

2 Soft to loud ★☆☆

Write these six signs in order, from the softest to the loudest: *mf* *pp* *f* *p* *ff* *mp*. The first is done.

pp ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

3 Louder or softer? ★☆☆

Does the music get louder or softer from the first sign to the second? The first is done.

mp → mf	**louder** · softer
f → p	louder · softer
pp → mp	louder · softer
ff → mf	louder · softer
p → f	louder · softer

4 Play it ★☆☆

Play Middle C six times: pp, p, mp, mf, f, ff. Six different steps? Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____
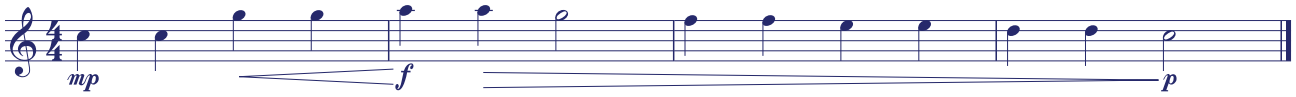
EXPRESSION · LOUD AND SOFT · USE

Loud and soft

REMEMBER A hairpin that opens grows louder (cresc.); one that closes fades (dim.).

1 Read the hairpins ★★☆

Look at the music and complete each sentence. The first is done.



It starts [mp] (sign).

The loudest note is in bar [ ] , marked [ ] .

It ends [ ] (sign).

2 Signs and words ★☆☆

Write what each one asks you to do. The first is done.

SIGN	WHAT YOU DO
cresc.	getting louder, little by little
dim.	
sfz	
fp	
subito p	

3 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

mf is louder than mp.	T F
A crescendo also gets faster.	T F
A dynamic lasts until the next one.	T F
sfz makes one note suddenly strong.	T F

4 Play it ★☆☆

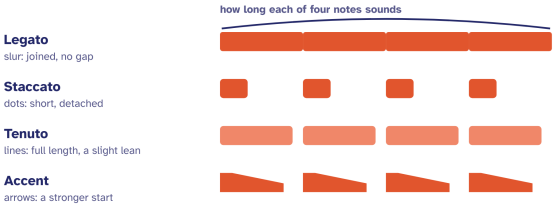
Play C D E F G growing from p to f, then come down fading to p, without speeding up. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · TOUCH · LEARN

Touch: smooth, short, strong



REMEMBER Curve: join. Dot: short. Line: hold. Arrow: strong.

1 Name the mark

★☆☆

Write the name and how to play it. The first row is done.

MARK	NAME	HOW
a dot	staccato	short, let go early
a curve over different notes		
a line		
> (an arrow)		
a wedge ▼		

2 Which notes are short?

★★☆

Look at the music and complete the sentences. The first is done.



Bar 1 is played [joined] (joined or short).

In bar 2, [ ] notes have dots.

The last G has an [ ] .

3 Slur or tie?

★☆☆

Circle slur or tie. The first is done.

a curve over C D E	(slur) · tie
a curve joining G and G	slur · tie
a curve over E F	slur · tie
a curve joining two Bs	slur · tie

4 Play it

★☆☆

Hot Cross Buns: play E D C joined, then short and bouncy. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · TOUCH · USE

Touch: smooth, short, strong

REMEMBER A two-note slur: drop into the first note, lift off the second.

1 Mood words ★☆☆

Write what each word means. The first is done.

WORD	MEANING
dolce	**sweetly**
cantabile	
leggiero	
espressivo	
maestoso	

2 Touch for the job ★★☆

Circle the touch that fits best. The first is done.

a lullaby	**legato** · staccato · accent
a bouncing ball	legato · staccato · accent
a march, with strong beats	legato · staccato · accent
a singing tune	legato · staccato · accent

3 Drop and lift ★☆☆

Each pair has a two-note slur. Write drop or lift under each note. The first is done.

PAIR	NOTE 1	NOTE 2
E–D	**drop**	**lift**
G–F		
C–B		

4 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

Staccato means loud.	T F
A tenuto note is held its full length.	T F
Lift your hand at the end of a slur.	T F

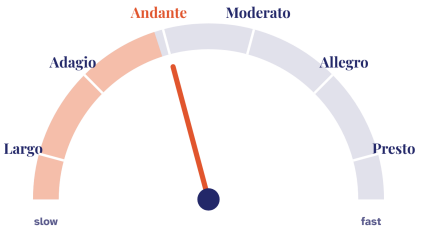
5 Play it ★☆☆

Play one bar of a piece three ways: all legato, all staccato, then as written. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · SPEED WORDS · LEARN



Speed words

REMEMBER Largo, Adagio, Andante, Moderato, Allegro, Presto: slow to fast. ♩ = 60 is one beat a second.

1 Slow to fast ★☆☆

Write these words in order, from the slowest to the fastest: Allegro, Largo, Andante, Presto, Adagio, Moderato. The first is done.

Largo _____ _____ _____ _____ _____

2 What does it mean? ★☆☆

Write the meaning. The first is done.

WORD	MEANING
Andante	at a walking pace
Allegro	
Adagio	
Presto	
Moderato	
Lento	

3 Metronome maths ★★☆

Complete each sentence. The first is done.

At ♩ = 60 there is one beat every [1] second(s).

At ♩ = 120 there are [ ] beats every second.

At ♩ = 30 there is one beat every [ ] seconds.

4 Play it ★☆☆

Walk at Andante saying 1 2 3 4, then jog at Allegro. Then clap both. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · SPEED WORDS · USE

Speed words

REMEMBER rit. and rall.: gradually slower. accel.: gradually faster. a tempo: back to the first speed.

1 Changing speed
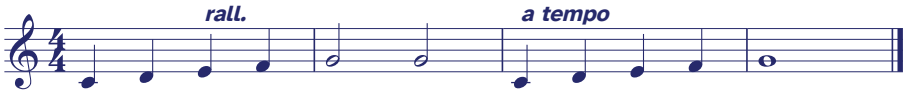
★☆☆

Write what each one asks. The first is done.

WORD OR SIGN	WHAT YOU DO
rit.	**gradually slower**
accel.	
a tempo	
rall.	
poco a poco	
più mosso	
fermata (pause)	

2 Read the map

★★☆

Look at the music and complete the sentences. The first is done.



The music slows down in bar [1] .

The first speed comes back in bar [ ] , at the words _____ .

3 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

Andante is very slow.	T F
A fermata means hold the note longer.	T F
meno mosso means faster.	T F

4 Play it

★☆☆

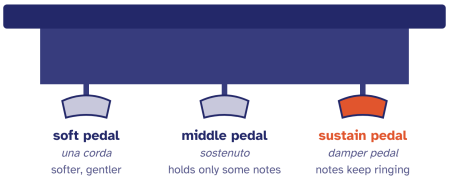
Play C D E F G and slow down into the G (rit.), then play it again a tempo. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · THE PEDALS · LEARN

The pedals



REMEMBER Ped.: right pedal down. ✻: up. Play first, then pedal.

1 Which pedal?
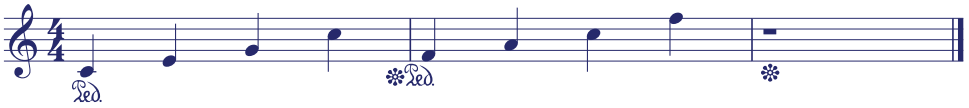
★☆☆

Write which pedal and what your foot does. The first row is done.

SIGN	PEDAL	FOOT
Ped.	**right**	**down**
✻		
u.c.		
t.c.		

2 Read the pedal

★★☆

Look at the music and complete the sentences. The first is done.



The pedal goes down on the first [C] .

It changes on the first note of bar [ ] .

It comes up in bar [ ] .

3 Play first, then pedal

★★☆

Number the steps of a pedal change in order. The first is done.

STEP	ORDER
play the new notes	1
press the pedal down again	
lift the pedal	

4 Play it

★☆☆

Play C E G together, press the pedal, take your hands off and listen. Lift the pedal. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · THE PEDALS · USE

The pedals

REMEMBER A new chord, a new pedal: play it, then change straight away.

1 Clean or muddy?

★★☆

Circle what you will hear. The first is done.

a change after every new chord	**clean** · muddy · a gap
the pedal held from C-E-G into F-A-C	clean · muddy · a gap
the pedal lifted before the new notes	clean · muddy · a gap
a change just after the new notes	clean · muddy · a gap

2 Where do you change?

★★☆

Each bar has one group of notes. Write down, change or none for each bar. The first is done.

BAR	PEDAL
bar 1: C E G	down
bar 2: C E G again	
bar 3: F A C	
bar 4: G B D	
bar 5: G B D again	

3 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

Keep your heel on the floor.	T F
u.c. is the right pedal.	T F
Change the pedal at the same moment as the new chord.	T F

4 Play it

★☆☆

Play C-E-G, F-A-C, G-B-D, C-E-G slowly with a change on each. Tick a circle each clean day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · ORNAMENTS · LEARN

Ornaments

REMEMBER An ornament borrows the next-door notes: one letter up or one letter down.

1 Name the ornament

★☆☆

Write the name of each one. The first is done.

SIGN	NAME
tr	trill
a zigzag	
a zigzag with a line through it	
a lying-down S (~)	
a tiny note with a slash	
a tiny note without a slash	

2 Next-door notes

★☆☆

Write the letter above and the letter below. The first row is done.

MAIN NOTE	ABOVE	BELOW
D	E	C
G		
A		
F		
B		

3 Spell it out

★★☆

Write the notes you play. The first is done.

ORNAMENT	NOTES
upper mordent on G	G A G
lower mordent on A	
turn on D	
trill on E (four notes)	

4 Play it

★☆☆

Play D and E with fingers 2 and 3, slowly, eight times, then a little faster. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · ORNAMENTS · USE

Ornaments

REMEMBER Slash: crushed in (acciaccatura). No slash: leans, taking half the time (appoggiatura).

1 Crushed or leaning?

★★☆

Circle the name. The first is done.

a tiny note with a slash	**acciaccatura** · appoggiatura
a tiny note without a slash	acciaccatura · appoggiatura
played as fast as possible	acciaccatura · appoggiatura
takes half the main note's time	acciaccatura · appoggiatura

2 Above or below?

★☆☆

Which next-door note does each use? Circle one. The first is done.

trill	**above** · below · both
upper mordent	above · below · both
lower mordent	above · below · both
turn	above · below · both

3 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

An ornament starts on the beat.	T F
A trill uses the note below.	T F
The main note still lands on time.	T F

4 Play it

★☆☆

Play C D E F G with an upper mordent on each note, slowly. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

5 Explain it

★★☆

In your own words: how do you play an upper mordent on D, and where does it start?

Date _____

EXPRESSION · REVIEW

Review

TEN MINUTES No help, no piano. Mark it with the answers on page 13.

1 Name them ★☆☆

Write what each one means.

mp	
rit.	
Ped.	
a dot over a note	

2 Complete it ★★☆

One word in each space.

Andante means at a ☐ pace.

A curve over different notes is a ☐ .

A trill goes back and forth with the note ☐ .

3 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

ff is softer than f.	T F
a tempo means back to the first speed.	T F
Change the pedal before you play the new chord.	T F

Score ☐ / 10

Date _____

EXPRESSION · PROGRESS

My progress

HOW TO USE Tick each column when it is true. Come back to this page every few weeks.

CONCEPT	I KNOW IT	I CAN WRITE IT	I CAN PLAY IT	HANDBOOK
dynamics: pp to ff	☐	☐	☐	p. 76
crescendo and diminuendo	☐	☐	☐	p. 76
slurs, staccato, tenuto, accents	☐	☐	☐	p. 79
mood words	☐	☐	☐	p. 79
tempo words and the metronome	☐	☐	☐	p. 82
rit., accel., a tempo, fermata	☐	☐	☐	p. 82
the sustain pedal	☐	☐	☐	p. 85
ornaments	☐	☐	☐	p. 88

Teacher's note

Date _____

EXPRESSION · ANSWERS

Answers

PAGE	ANSWERS
p. 1	Say it: mf mezzo-forte half loud · ff fortissimo very loud · mp mezzo-piano half soft · pp pianissimo very soft · f forte loud. Order: pp p mp mf f ff. Louder/softer: louder, softer, louder, softer, louder.
p. 2	Hairpins: mp; bar 2, f; p. Signs: dim. getting softer · sfz one note suddenly strong · fp loud, then soft at once · subito p suddenly soft. T/F: T, F, T, T.
p. 3	Marks: slur, join smoothly · tenuto, hold full length · accent, a stronger start · staccatissimo, very short. Short notes: joined; two; accent. Slur or tie: slur, tie, slur, tie.
p. 4	Mood words: in a singing style · lightly · with feeling · majestically. Touch: legato, staccato, accent, legato. Drop and lift: drop, lift (every pair). T/F: F, T, T.
p. 5	Order: Largo, Adagio, Andante, Moderato, Allegro, Presto. Meanings: fast and lively · slow, at ease · very fast · moderate · slow. Metronome: 1; 2; 2.
p. 6	Changing speed: gradually faster · back to the speed before · gradually slower · little by little · more movement, faster · hold longer than written. Map: bar 1; bar 3, a tempo. T/F: F, T, F.
p. 7	Pedals: right, up · left, down · left, up. Read the pedal: C; bar 2; bar 3. Order: play 1, lift 2, press down again 3.
p. 8	Clean or muddy: clean, muddy, a gap, clean. Where: none, change, change, none. T/F: T, F, F.
p. 9	Names: upper mordent, lower mordent, turn, acciaccatura, appoggiatura. Next door: G A F · A B G · F G E · B C A. Spell: A G A · E D C D · E F E F.
p. 10	Crushed or leaning: acciaccatura, appoggiatura, acciaccatura, appoggiatura. Above or below: above, above, below, both. T/F: T, F, T.
p. 11	half soft · gradually slower · right pedal down · short (staccato). walking; slur; above. F, T, F.

“Play it”, “in your music”, listening and playing have no single answer to copy: check them at the piano with your teacher, or with the online lessons.

Date _____